General Bite #1: General-Class Privileges

What you can do with a General license: HF and MF band privileges, segments, secondary-user rules, the General/Extra split.

Group G1A · 10 pool questions · 5-10 minute presentation · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

The Big Picture

Upgrading to General opens significant HF privileges that Technicians don't have. The exam wants you to know: which bands have General-class restrictions, which sub-bands are reserved to Extra, where phone vs CW vs image is allowed, and what "secondary" status means.

Bands With General-Class Sub-Band Restrictions

Which HF/MF bands have portions where General licensees cannot transmit? 80, 40, 20, and 15 meters (G1A01). These four bands have segments reserved exclusively for Extra (and historically Advanced) class operators – generals are kept out of those slices.

Question	Answer	Q
Bands with Extra-only segments	**80, 40, 20, and 15 meters** (G1A08).	G1A08
Where in the voice segment do Generals operate when not allowed the full segment?	**The upper frequency portion** (G1A11). One rule, every band: 40 m phone 7.175-7.300, 20 m phone 14.225-14.350, 15 m phone 21.275-21.450. Generals are always in the upper slice.	G1A11
Frequencies Generals are NOT allowed as control op	**7.125-7.175 MHz** is the Extra-only 40m phone segment. (G1A05)	G1A05

Mode-Specific Band Rules

Restriction	Where it applies	Q
Phone prohibited	**30 meters** (G1A02). 30m is digital/CW only.	G1A02
Image prohibited	**30 meters** (G1A03). Same band, same reason.	G1A03
CW emissions on 10 m	**The entire band** (G1A07). Generals get all of 10m for CW.	G1A07
Repeater portion of 10 m	**Above 29.5 MHz** (G1A10). The 10m repeater sub-band.	G1A10

Secondary-User Status

When the FCC designates amateur service as a secondary user on a band: Amateur stations must not cause harmful interference to primary users, and must accept interference from primary users. (G1A06)

Plain English: on a band where we are secondary, the primary user (often a government service or commercial allocation) has priority. We have to listen first, work around them, and live with their interference. Examples: 60 meters and 30 meters (the two HF amateur allocations with secondary status). 17 m and 12 m are amateur primary, not secondary.

One Frequency Pinpoint Question

G1A09: Which of these frequencies is within the General portion of 15 m?
21300 kHz. The General 15 m phone segment runs from 21.275 MHz to 21.450 MHz; 21.300 MHz falls squarely inside it. (21.225-21.275 MHz is Extra-only.)

The other choices (14250 in 20m, 18155 in 17m, 24900 in 12m) are on the wrong bands for the question.

Mental Cheat Sheet

- Bands with Extra-only phone segments: **80, 40, 20, 15**.
- 30 m: **no phone, no image**. CW/digital only.
- 10 m: Generals get the **entire band** for CW. Repeaters above 29.5 MHz.
- When in a band where Generals share with Extras, Generals always get the **upper** portion of the phone segment (40 m: 7.175+, 20 m: 14.225+, 15 m: 21.275+).
- 7.125-7.175 MHz is **Extra-only** (Generals stay out).
- 21.300 MHz is **inside** the General 15 m phone segment.
- Secondary user = no interference to primaries, must accept their interference.

Common Traps

- The "no phone" band is **30 m**, not 17 m or 12 m.
- The "no image" band is also **30 m** (same reason).
- Image is prohibited on 30 m (same as phone). 60 m phone is allowed but image is not – two HF exceptions. (The exam only tests 30 m on G1A03.)
- On 40 m phone, **7.125-7.175 MHz is Extra-only** – the trap answer in G1A05 is to think the segment is open to Generals.

- Secondary status does NOT mean “only during emergencies” or “only at specific hours.” It means no interference, accept interference.
- 10 m repeaters are **above 29.5 MHz**, not above 29.0 or below 28.5.

Takeaway: The General license opens HF, but 80/40/20/15 each have an Extra-only phone slice you cannot use. 30 m is special: no phone, no image, ever. On bands where amateurs are secondary, primary users have priority. The General-vs-Extra split rule is simple: Generals always get the **upper** portion of the phone segment.

Bite 1 Question Bank (G1A)

G1A01. On which HF and/or MF amateur bands are there portions where General class licensees cannot transmit?
A. 60 meters, 30 meters, 17 meters, and 12 meters.
B. 160 meters, 60 meters, 15 meters, and 12 meters.
C. 80 meters, 40 meters, 20 meters, and 15 meters.
D. 80 meters, 20 meters, 15 meters, and 10 meters.

G1A02. On which of the following bands is phone operation prohibited?
A. 160 meters.
B. 30 meters.
C. 17 meters.
D. 12 meters.

G1A03. On which of the following bands is image transmission prohibited?
A. 160 meters.
B. 30 meters.
C. 20 meters.
D. 12 meters.

G1A05. On which of the following frequencies are General class licensees prohibited from operating as control operator?
A. 7.125 MHz to 7.175 MHz.
B. 28.000 MHz to 28.025 MHz.
C. 21.275 MHz to 21.300 MHz.
D. All these choices are correct.

G1A06. Which of the following applies when the FCC rules designate the amateur service as a secondary user on a band?
A. Amateur stations must record the call sign of the primary service station before operating on a frequency assigned to that station.
B. Amateur stations may use the band only during emergencies.
C. Amateur stations must not cause harmful interference to primary users and must accept interference from primary users.
D. Amateur stations may only operate during specific hours of the day, while primary users are permitted 24-hour use of the band.

G1A07. On which amateur frequencies in the 10-meter band may stations with a General class control operator transmit CW emissions?
A. 28.000 MHz to 28.025 MHz only.
B. 28.000 MHz to 28.300 MHz only.
C. 28.025 MHz to 28.300 MHz only.
D. The entire band.

G1A08. Which HF bands have segments exclusively allocated to Amateur Extra licensees?
A. All HF bands.
B. 80 meters, 40 meters, 20 meters, and 15 meters.
C. All HF bands except 160 meters and 10 meters.
D. 60 meters, 30 meters, 17 meters, and 12 meters.

G1A09. Which of the following frequencies is within the General class portion of the 15-meter band?
A. 14250 kHz.
B. 18155 kHz.
C. 21300 kHz.
D. 24900 kHz.

G1A10. What portion of the 10-meter band is available for repeater use?
A. The entire band.
B. The portion between 28.1 MHz and 28.2 MHz.
C. The portion between 28.3 MHz and 28.5 MHz.
D. The portion above 29.5 MHz.

G1A11. When General class licensees are not permitted to use the entire voice portion of a band, which portion of the voice segment is available to them?
A. The lower frequency portion.
B. The upper frequency portion.
C. The lower frequency portion on frequencies below 7.3 MHz, and the upper portion on frequencies above 14.150 MHz.
D. The upper frequency portion on frequencies below 7.3 MHz, and the lower portion on frequencies above 14.150 MHz.

Answer Key

G1A01: C G1A02: B G1A03: B G1A05: A
G1A06: C G1A07: D G1A08: B G1A09: C
G1A10: D G1A11: B